

Introduction

Some medicines cannot be taken with certain types of food as it can cause a reaction that changes the effect of the medicine which may lead to side effects. An example of this is having grapefruit or grapefruit juice with cholesterol drugs. On the other hand, some medicines are easier to handle when taken with food. If you don't take them with food, you may feel nauseous or dizzy. Food and Drug Administration (FDA), US has published a guidance for public on avoid of food-drug interaction included most common interactions between food and drug. This document provides a policy and procedure for most common drug-food interactions.

Scope

This document is applicable to Pharmacy professionals and other linked health care workers dealing with clinical area in royal hospital.

Purpose

To provide a local policy on common Drug-Food interaction in general and recommended instructions to counsel the patients.

Definition

1. Drug-Food Interaction: The effect produced when some drugs and certain foods or beverages are taken at the same time. A clinically significant interaction is one that causes a therapeutic failure and/or toxicity in the patient.
2. Patient Medication Profile: A comprehensive summary of all regular medication taken by a patient, including prescription, over-the-counter and complementary medicines.

Policy

1. A common Drug-Food and Drug-Drug Interactions Chart listing medications including the name of the drug, type of food, mechanism of interaction, and patient counseling must be posted in outpatient and inpatient pharmacy, as quick reference.

2. Any information about history of food-drug interaction should be incorporated into the patient medication profile and counseling patients on the potential effects of these interactions and how to avoid those.

Procedure

1. The Pharmacist shall check for interactions including drug–nutrient, drug–drug, drug–patient, and drug–disease interactions and identify mechanism of the interaction & consider clinical significance. Decide on an appropriate course of action.
2. Al Shifa (national electronic medical record) will alert the prescriber in case of drug-food interactions.
3. The Pharmacist shall educate patients and/or their families about potential **clinically significant** food-drug interactions. Patients who will be discharged on drugs with potentially significant food-drug interactions shall receive counseling on dietary restrictions prior to discharge. Using preprinted food-drug literature and handouts given to patients are helpful.
4. The Pharmacists, will monitor for the adverse drug-food interactions and should report any adverse reactions.
5. In providing drug information to patients, Pharmacists often discuss potential side effects and how the medication should be taken.
6. The Pharmacist calls the prescriber whenever the potential for a medication-food interaction exists and document the communication and follow-up action on the prescription.

References

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